



The Athleader Playbook

M.V.P.  Accelerator™
POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™



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Welcome, Athleader!

The document you are holding is not a workbook. It is your **High-performance Playbook**. It is the most critical piece of equipment you will use during your Championship Season in the M.V.P. Accelerator. This is your foundation for forever.

The videos provide the strategy and inspiration from me, but this Playbook is where you put in the work. It's where you'll build the "muscle memory" of an elite leader by integrating the elite mindset of athletes with the mastery of leadership into your daily actions. The "drills" within these pages are designed to move you from knowing to *doing*.

Your M.V.P. + V (mission, vision, purpose and values) is your foundation, authentically grounding your leadership identity. How you activate it in real time is from your Core 4: Agility, Resilience, Alignment and Wellbeing (A.R.A.W.). This is what distinguishes Athleadership as a philosophy and system rooted in neuroscience, performance psychology and enterprise application.

Use this space in this playbook to reflect deeply, plan strategically, and commit to action. Right now, establish the time you will commit to make this a priority: block 60 minutes on your calendar each week (in one block or across multiple times) and schedule a meeting with yourself to ensure you don't allow anyone else to take this valuable time away from an investment in yourself. This is your journey. Own it.

You've got this!

CEO, Velvet Suite
Founder, Athleadership® Movement



Leadership Conditioning System:

A.R.A.W. (Core 4)

Athleadership Arena is the first Leadership Performance System built like sport—conditioning character, mindset, and scaling measurable performance impact through **Agility, Resilience, Alignment and Wellbeing**.

Our proprietary system will condition your ability to lead through pressure and change with purpose.





Lesson 1

Suit Up & Enter the Arena

Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 1

► Primary A.R.A.W. Focus:

Alignment

Aligning with your personal goals, the program's vision, and your own "why."

Agility

Making the mental shift from "training" to active "conditioning."

► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Understand the core philosophy of Athleadership and the program's "Championship Season" structure.
- » Set a powerful intention that will serve as your fuel for the next 10 weeks.
- » Establish your initial A.R.A.W. (Core 4) baseline to measure your growth.
- » Make a firm commient to yourself and your development.
- » Commit the time on your calendar to invest in your conditioning experience.



Video Debrief Zone

Use this space to capture key ideas, “aha” moments, and powerful quotes from Melissa’s coaching in the Lesson 1 video. What resonated most with you?



Key Idea 1 (Athleadership & A.R.A.W.):



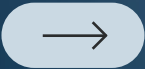
Key Idea 2 (M.V.P. Blueprint & 90-Day Way):



A Powerful Quote That Stood Out:

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills

This is where you start putting in the reps.



Drill 1.1

Setting Your ‘Why’ (Your Championship Season Intention)

In the video, Melissa challenged you to set the intention that will fuel your entire journey. This is the first and most critical step. A powerful “why” can get you through any “how.”

Your task is to set one clear professional goal and one clear personal goal for this 10-week season. Make note as you will come back to this as you draft your 90-day plan as well as assess your final progress at the end.



Professional Goal: What is the single most important professional outcome you want to achieve in the next 10 weeks?



Personal Goal: What is the single most important personal outcome you want to achieve in the next 10 weeks?

 Your “Why”: Why are these transformations so important to you right now? What will achieving them unlock for you, and who else will benefit (your team, your family, your company)?

Your Core Intention: Now, distill this down into one powerful sentence for your M.V.P. Accelerator journey.

 My Intention: _____



Great leaders
don’t wait for
change; they
create it.

Drill 1.2

Your Initial A.R.A.W.
Baseline Check

This isn't a test. It's your starting point. Be honest with yourself. On a scale of 1 (Needs Significant Conditioning) to 5 (Currently a Key Strength), rate your current capacity in each of the Core 4 leadership muscles.

 Agility

My ability to adapt to change, pivot quickly, and make decisions under pressure:



 Resilience

My ability to bounce back from setbacks, manage stress, and maintain a positive mindset:



 Alignment

My ability to align my daily actions with my deeper purpose and values, and to communicate clearly with my team and Player-Coach:



 Well-being

My ability to manage my energy, prioritize recovery, and sustain high performance without burnout:



The Athleader’s Commient

Champions are defined by their commients. This is your contract with yourself.

I, _____, commit to this 10-week Championship Season. I will show up fully for myself, engage honestly with the material in this Playbook, and hold myself accountable for the growth I am here to achieve.

Name / Signature:

Date:

Your Core Tool: The 90-Day Way Scorecard

Throughout this program, you will use the 90-Day Way Scorecard as your primary tool for planning and tracking your progress. This is the system that turns your M.V.P. Blueprint into real-world results. It is a reusable, season-after-season system for continuous growth.

Your Task:

- 1

Locate and download the 90-Day Way Core 4 Scorecard.docx from your program materials.
- 2

Familiarize yourself with the structure. Notice how it includes sections for your M.V.P. Blueprint, your high-level goals, and a review cadence for weekly, monthly, and even quarterly check-ins. This is an evergreen tool designed to serve you long after you complete this course.
- 3

For now, your only task is to review the first page: when ready, fill in the M.V.P.+V (Mission, Vision, Purpose, and Values) that you will architect.

We will activate the rest of this Scorecard in later lessons as you begin to set your goals and execute your plan.

 My notes

“My manager is not participating in this experience”

That’s okay. Your Player-Coach does not have to be your direct manager. Depending on your role, you may have one manager, multiple managers, or no participating manager. You can choose a peer, mentor, or trusted colleague to support your journey. When you see “Player-Coach,” think of the person you’ve chosen to support you. However, only company selected managers will have access to the manager track of the M.V.P. Accelerator.



Lesson 2

Pre-Season Conditioning (*Inner Blueprint Discovery*)

Welcome to your Pre-Season Conditioning. In the Arena, victory isn't just about what you do; it's about who you are. This lesson is your dedicated time to conduct a "scouting report" on yourself. The self-awareness you build here—understanding your values, strengths, energy, and key life moments—is the foundation for authentic and powerful leadership.

This is the discovery phase. Give yourself the space to be honest and insightful. The work you do here provides the "raw materials" you will use to architect your M.V.P. Blueprint in Lesson 3.



**"To go fast,
we first have
to go deep."**



Pre-Game Huddle: *Your Focus for Lesson 2*

► Primary A.R.A.W. Focus:

Well-being

Cultivating deep self-awareness is the first step to managing your energy and sustaining peak performance.

Resilience

Understanding your past challenges and successes builds the mental and emotional muscle to navigate future pressure.

► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Identify 3-5 non-negotiable Core Values that act as your leadership compass.
- » Distinguish between learned skills and true, energizing strengths.
- » Conduct a personal Energy Audit to identify what fuels you and what drains you.
- » Review your personal “Game Tape” to extract critical lessons from past experiences.



Video Debrief Zone

Use this space to capture key ideas, “aha” moments, and powerful quotes from Melissa’s coaching in the Lesson 2 video topics. What resonated most with you?



Key Idea 1 (My Core Values):

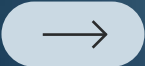


Key Idea 2 (My Strengths & Energy):



Key Idea 3 (My ‘Game Tape’):

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 2.1

Discover Your Core Values

Your values are your personal “True North.” They guide your decisions when the path forward is unclear. The goal here is not to create a long list, but to identify the 3-5 values that are absolutely essential to who you are.



Instructions:
Review the list of values below. Circle all that resonate with you. Then, from your circled list, narrow it down to the top 5 that you would follow at the expense of all others. Finally, write those 5 in the “My Core Values” section.

Values List Sampler:

Accountability | Achievement |
Adventure | Alignment | Authenticity
| Balance | Belonging | Boldness |
Challenge | Community | Compassion
| Competence | Confidence |
Connection | Contribution | Courage
| Creativity | Curiosity | Discipline |
Empathy | Excellence | Fairness |
Faith | Family | Freedom | Growth |
Harmony | Honesty | Humility | Impact
| Innovation | Integrity | Joy | Justice
| Kindness | Knowledge | Leadership
| Loyalty | Mastery | Openness |
Optimism | Passion | Patience | Peace
| Perseverance | Recognition | Respect
| Responsibility | Security | Service
| Spirituality | Stability | Strength |
Success | Teamwork | Trust | Truth |
Vision | Wealth | Wisdom

My Core Values:

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Drill 2.2

Identify Your Strengths

A strength isn't just something you're good at; it's an activity that energizes you. When you're operating from your strengths, you feel in a state of flow. Reflect on the following prompts to identify your natural advantages.

- » What activities make you lose track of time?
- » What kind of problems do you enjoy solving for others?
- » What are you doing when you feel most confident and effective?
- » What do people consistently compliment you on or come to you for help with?
- » After which activities do you feel more energized than when you started?



My notes



Your Energy Audit

Energy, not time, is your most valuable currency. Identifying your “drains” and “fuels” is the first step toward managing your energy for peak performance.

 **Identify Your Drains:** List 3-5 people, tasks, or environments that consistently drain your energy.

**Example**
Weekly 2-hour status report meeting.

»

»

»

»

»

»

 **Identify Your Fuels:** List 3-5 people, tasks, or environments that consistently energize you and fuel your passion.

**Example**
1-on-1 mentoring session with my direct report

»

»

»

»

»

»

Alignment Summary Grid

Now, synthesize your discoveries from the drills above.

Element	Currently Aligned? (Y/N)	What's Working?	What's Missing or Misaligned?
My Core Values			
My Strengths			
My Energy			

Review Your “Game Tape”

Your past experiences hold the data for your future success. We look back not with judgment, but with the curious eyes of a Player-Coach.

Peak Performance Moment

Describe a specific time in your life or career when you were “in the zone” and performing at your absolute best. What was the situation? What were you doing? What made it a success? What strengths were you using?

Resilience Moment

Describe a time you faced a significant challenge or setback. How did you feel, and what actions did you take to navigate through it or bounce back? What did you learn about your resilience from this experience?

Change Navigation Reflection

Think of a recent change you navigated. What value or strength helped you? What blind spot did this situation reveal?

Locker Room Reflection

After completing the drills for this lesson, what is the single most important insight you’ve gained about your Inner Blueprint? How will you apply this insight in how you lead yourself—and others—in the next 30 days?

Think about a recent season of high change or transition (merger, reorg, personal loss, promotion, etc.). How did your values, energy, or strengths show up—or not? What would you do differently now using this Inner Blueprint?

Metric (1-10 Pulse)

On a scale of 1-10, how equipped do you feel to lead yourself through change after this reflection?



 My notes



Lesson 3

Game Plan – Define Your M.V.P. & The 90-Day Way

Welcome to the architecture phase. In Lesson 2, you did the deep work of discovery and gathered the essential “raw materials” of your Inner Blueprint. Now, you will use those powerful insights to construct the single most important tool for your leadership journey: your M.V.P. Blueprint.

This is where your purpose gets a roadmap. **But it’s more than a personal map; it’s an alignment tool that clarifies how you show up as a leader and builds a foundation of trust with your Player-Coach and your team.** This lesson is challenging, but it is also where your vision starts to become real. Choose progress over perfection. The goal is to get a powerful first draft down; you can, and should, refine it over time.



“A goal
without a plan
is just a wish.”



Pre-Game Huddle: *Your Focus for Lesson 3*

► Primary A.R.A.W. Focus:

Alignment

Architecting a clear M.V.P. Blueprint that aligns your purpose, vision, and daily actions **with the needs of your team and organization.**

Agility

Creating a game plan that is both focused and flexible enough to adapt to real-world changes.

► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Draft a compelling Purpose Statement (Your “Why”).
- » Draft a vivid Vision Statement (Your “Where”).
- » Draft an action-oriented Mission Statement (Your “How”).
- » Understand how your M.V.P. Blueprint creates clarity and sets expectations with your Player-Coach.
- » **Understand how your M.V.P. Blueprint serves as the foundation for setting A.R.A.W.-focused goals in the 90-Day Way Scorecard.**

 Video Debrief Zone

Use this space to capture key ideas, “aha” moments, and powerful quotes from Melissa’s coaching in the Lesson 3 video topics.

 **My “Why” (Purpose):**

 **My “Where” (Vision):**

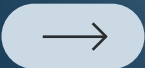
 **My “How” (Mission):**

 **The 90-Day Way:**



Purpose isn’t
a luxury—it’s
your leadership
advantage.

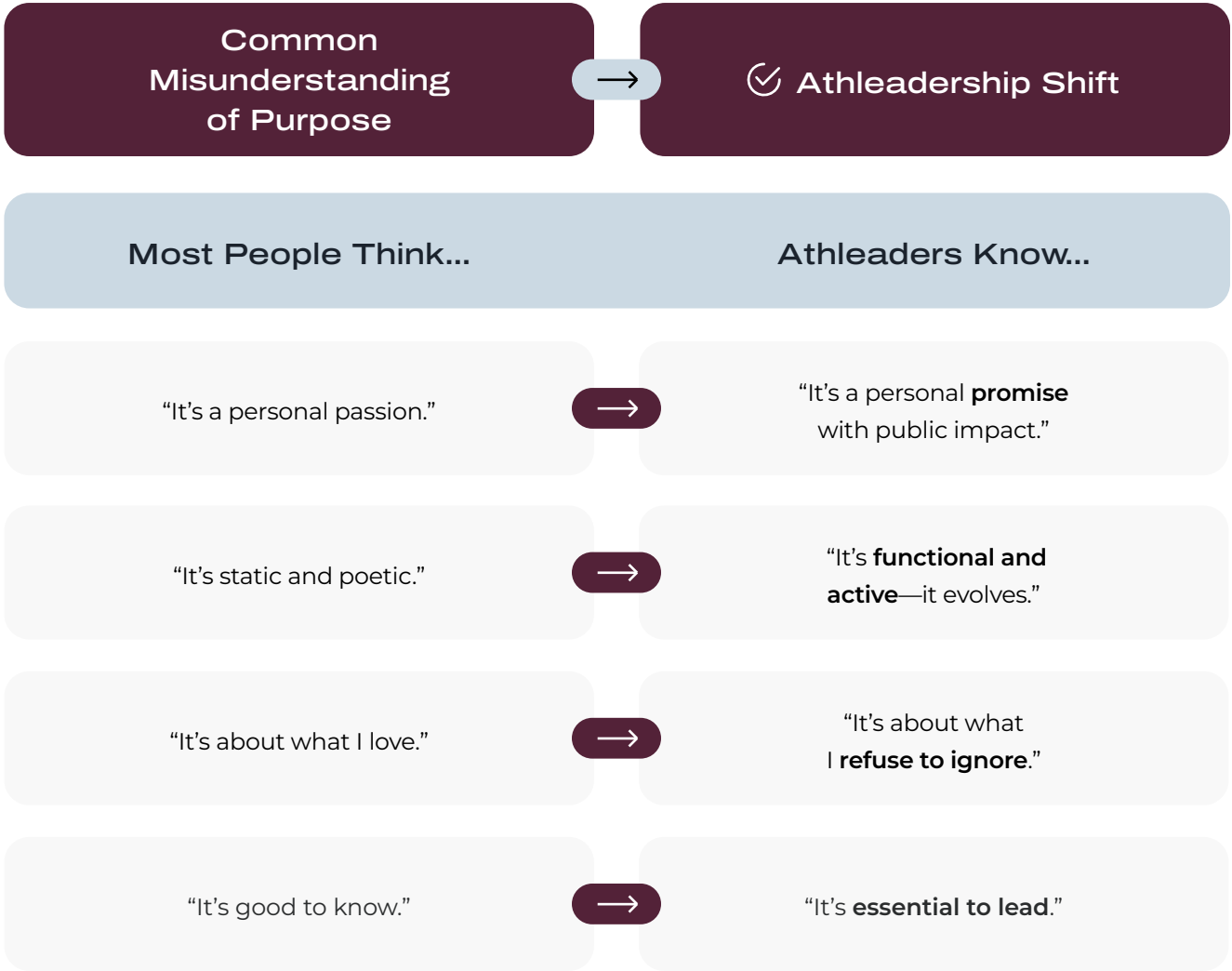
A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 3.1

Architect Your Purpose Statement (Your “Why”)

- » Purpose isn’t a statement. It’s a leadership anchor and a decision filter.
- » Your purpose is the authentic engine behind why you are here. It’s not about feeling good—it’s about realizing the original intention for your life and leadership that fuels forward motion when things get hard. It’s the reason people trust you, follow you, and stay with you in high-stakes moments.



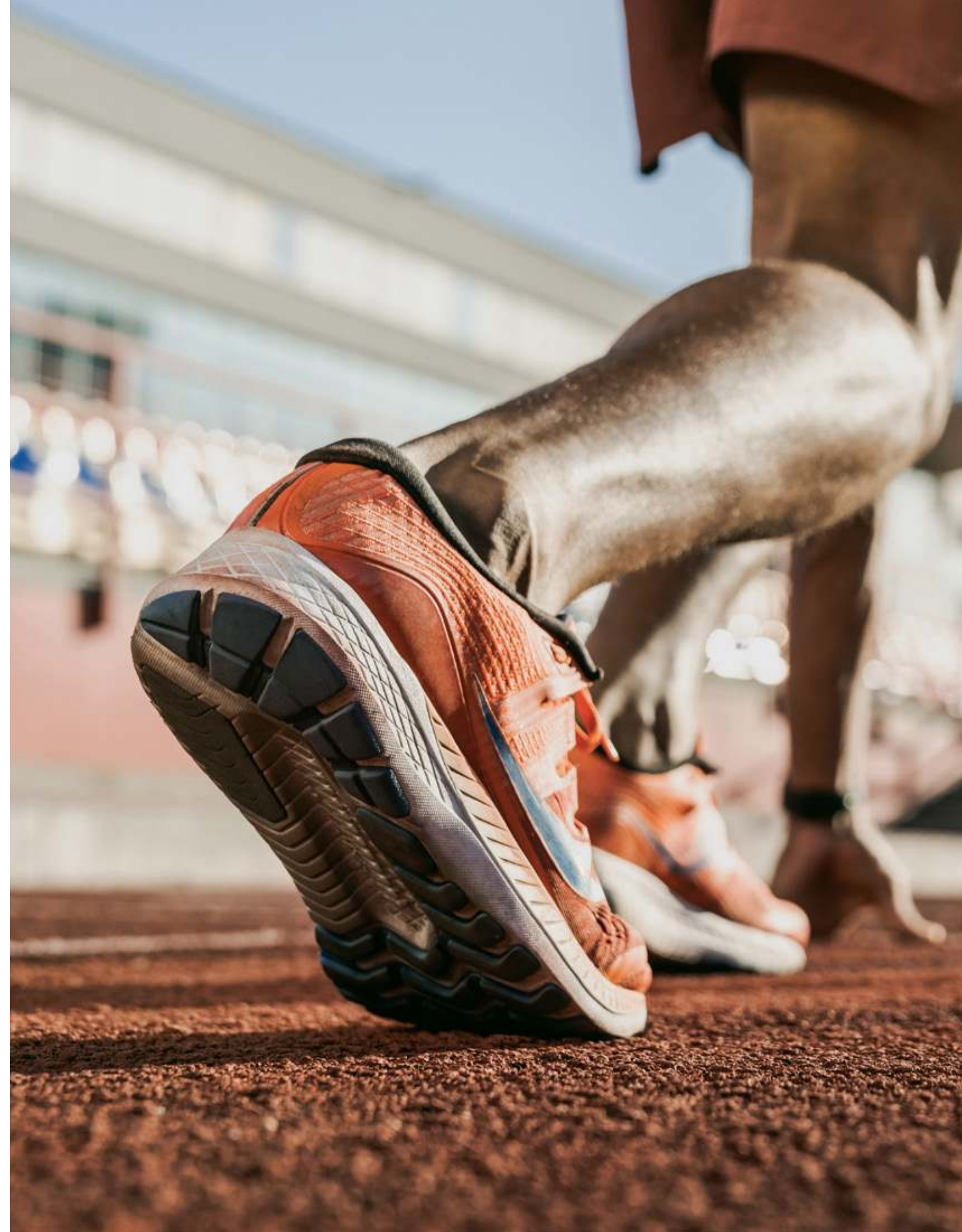
The Drafting Process

Step 1

Gather Your Raw Materials (Your Inner Blueprint)

To build your purpose, you first need to gather the raw materials. Use the prompts below to brainstorm. Don't censor yourself—just write.

- » Who am I at my core, beyond my job title?
- » How do I aspire to serve or impact others (my Player-Coach, my team, my family, my community)?
- » What is the unique legacy I want to leave?
- » If my job ended today, what would still drive me to serve?
- » What do others say I ignite in them?



Step 2

Understand the Framework

Now, we will use a specific framework to structure your purpose statement. This framework connects your core action to its impact across every arena of your life.

The Framework



I exist to [Core Action/Impact] by [Your Method or Mindset] so that [Result in Others - in Work, in Life, and in Legacy].



Example

- **Full Statement:** *I exist to **bring order to chaos** by **leading with calm and clarity**, so that **others can rise with confidence**—as a father who models peace under pressure, in my leadership through complex change, and by leaving behind a legacy of grounded, values-based decision-making.*
- **This purpose in action across life's arenas:**
 - » **Family:** *I teach my children how to face challenges without losing themselves.*
 - » **Leadership:** *I simplify the storm so my team can execute with focus.*
 - » **Legacy:** *I am remembered as the person who brought stability when others panicked.*



Step 3

Write Your First Draft

Using your brainstorming notes and the framework above, write the first draft of your purpose statement and its application in your life's arenas.



My Purpose is:

I exist to _____
by _____
so that _____



Family (Your closest relationships):



Leadership (Your team/colleagues):



Legacy (Your long-term impact)

Step 4

Refine and Align

A truly authentic purpose takes time. Be prepared to write 5, 10, or even 25 drafts. Use these prompts to refine your work:

- » **Review it:** Does it align with your core values? Does it feel true to you?
- » **Keep it Concise:** Can you make your main statement even more powerful and clear?
- » **Read it Aloud:** Does it energize you? It should feel like fuel.
- » **Align with Your Player-Coach:** How would sharing this purpose with your Player-Coach help them understand what truly motivates you and where to find opportunities for your growth and development?

Drill 3.2

Architect Your Vision Statement (Your “Where”)

What is a Best-in-Class Vision?

Vision is a vivid destination of where you aspire for your personal and professional leadership to go. It's not just dreaming big; it is defining success on your terms with specificity. A powerful vision not only motivates you to keep moving forward, but it also inspires your team, your family, and others to keep moving ahead when the way is uncertain.

A best-in-class vision statement is:

- » **Vivid:** It creates a clear, detailed picture in your mind.
- » **Visible:** You can see it, feel it, and almost touch it.
- » **Real:** It feels authentic and possible, even if it's a stretch.



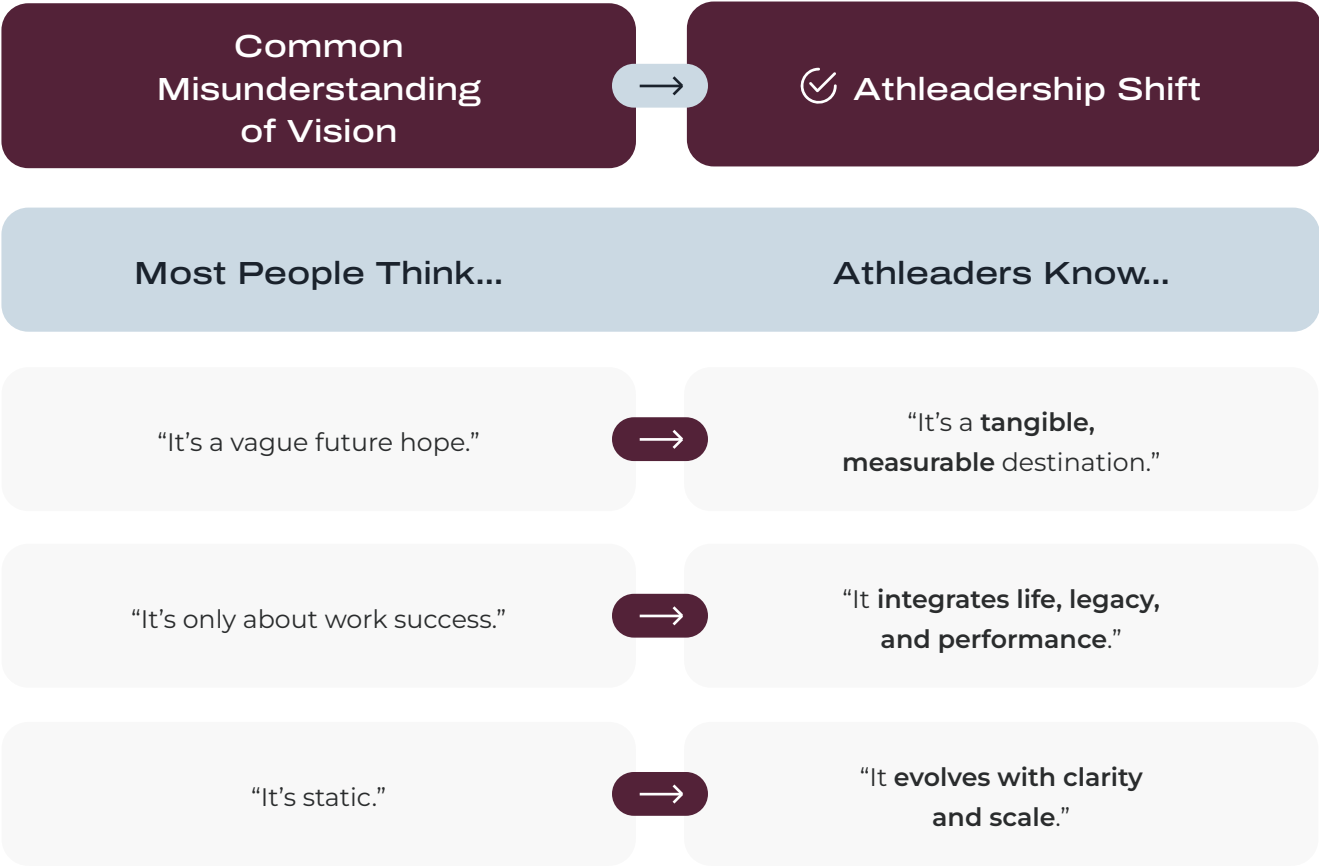
The Drafting Process

Step 1

Gather Your Raw Materials

Go back to the intention you set in Lesson 1 and use your reflections from Lesson 2 to answer the prompts below. These answers will form the building blocks of your vision.

- » Fast forward 5 years. What does ultimate success look like for you professionally? (What is your role? What are you known for? What impact are you having?)
- » In that same 5-year future, what does success personally look like for you? (Consider your health, relationships, learning, and overall well-being.)
- » What does it feel like to be in that future? What emotions come up?
- » What are people saying about your impact?
- » What in your future vision energizes you when current circumstances don't?



You won't rise to the level of your potential—you fall to the strength of your conditioning.

Step 2

Draft Your Vision Statement

Using your answers, draft a statement that captures the essence of your future self.



Example

- » *In 5 years, I am leading a cross-functional team known for execution under pressure, mentoring rising leaders, and protecting time for family, health, and impact beyond work.*
- » *I'm a trusted voice in strategic transformation, known for helping companies navigate disruption while staying rooted in integrity and people-first leadership.*
- » *In 3 years, I've built a platform that develops young athletes into confident leaders—on the field, in the boardroom, and in their communities.*



My Vision is:



Alignment in action

Connecting Your “Where”

- » How does your professional vision align with the known goals of your team and the wider organization?
- » What conversation could you have with your Player-Coach to share this vision and discuss developmental opportunities that would support it?



BONUS DRILL → Make it Visible

A vision you can see is one you can achieve. Create a Vision Board (digital or physical) to bring your statement to life with images,

quotes, and words that represent your future. Take up a level, put your M.V.P. in AI and gain a more vivid picture for where your life can go!



My Notes:

Drill 3.3

Architect Your Mission Statement (Your “How”)

What is a Best-in-Class Mission?

A Mission Statement is designed to define a task or assignment. **It's not aspirational; it's directional. It's the daily behavior that makes your purpose real and moves you toward your vision.** Your mission shapes your activities, resources, and time, creating alignment in your career. It can and should evolve, but it should always reflect where you are today.

A best-in-class Mission defines:

- 1 Who you are
- 2 How you live
- 3 The skills you bring
- 4 The results you want to achieve



The Drafting Process

Step 1

Understand the Core Components (The Formula)

Your mission statement is built from four key parts that clarify your action and impact.

The Formula → I will [ACTION] for [AUDIENCE] by [FOCUS AREA] to [RESULT].

Action

How you move (e.g., Build, Coach, Challenge, Protect, Translate, Activate)

Audience

Who you're responsible for (e.g., My team, rising leaders, my industry, my clients)

Focus Area

Your method or superpower (e.g., Simplifying complexity, connecting vision to action, translating data into stories)

Result

The change you drive (e.g., High performance, strategic momentum, a culture of confidence)

Step 2



Review Examples

- » “I will **build clarity** for **my team** by **simplifying complexity** to **create a culture of confidence, execution, and trust under pressure.**”
- » “I will **empower decision-makers** by **connecting the dots between vision and action** to **drive strategic momentum through people and performance.**”
- » “I will **coach high-potential performers** by **translating the mindset of elite sport** into **leadership habits that win in life and business.**”



My notes

Step 3

Draft Your Mission Statement

Use the formula and examples to architect your mission. First, fill in the blanks, then combine them into a full statement.

ACTION: _____

AUDIENCE: _____

FOCUS AREA: _____

RESULT: _____



My Mission is:

→|← Alignment in action

Connecting Your “Where”

Review your mission. How does this ‘how’ provide clarity to your team and set clear expectations for the work you will prioritize together?

The System for Momentum: The 90-Day Way

You now have the first draft of your M.V.P. Blueprint. This is your strategic compass **and your alignment tool**. The 90-Day Way Scorecard is the vehicle that will move you forward.

Your Task:

- 1 Review your **M.V.P. Blueprint** drafts (Purpose, Vision, Mission) that you just completed.
- 2 Open your [90-Day Way_Core 4 Scorecard.docx](#) document.
- 3 Complete **Part 1: M.V.P. Foundation**. Transfer your drafted Purpose, Vision, and Mission statements into the scorecard. Also, add the core Values you identified in Lesson 2.

This is a critical step in activating your blueprint. In the next lessons, we will use this foundation to build out your actionable goals within the scorecard.

Locker Room Reflection

After drafting your M.V.P. Blueprint, what is the most clarifying insight you've had about your path forward, and how do you think it will positively impact your relationship with your Player-Coach or team?

 My notes



Lesson 3

Reflections

Based upon your M.V.P. draft,
reflect on the following.

1

I use or will use my M.V.P. as a decision filter in moments of pressure.



Strongly Agree



Agree



Neutral



Disagree



Strongly Disagree

2

My current role allows me to live my purpose.



Strongly Agree



Agree



Neutral



Disagree



Strongly Disagree

3

My M.V.P. draft gives my Player-Coach a clearer picture of my career aspirations.



Strongly Agree



Agree



Neutral



Disagree



Strongly Disagree

4

I feel more energized because I'm living in alignment with my M.V.P.



Strongly Agree



Agree



Neutral



Disagree



Strongly Disagree



Reflection

Based upon your answers, how can you leverage your 90-Day Way to make adjustments?





Lesson 4

Activate Your M.V.P. & Condition A.R.A.W.

Welcome to the game. You've done the strategic work to create your M.V.P. Blueprint. Now, we move from the strategy session to the playing field. This lesson is about how to condition your ability to execute with purpose when faced with the inevitable resistance and unpredictability of the real world.

This is where you build the core muscles of an Athleader: Resilience and Agility. The drills in this section are designed to be your "weight training"—they will challenge you, strengthen your core, and prepare you to lead with confidence when it matters most. refine it over time.



**"The plan is not
the victory. The
victory is in the
execution."**



Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 4

► Primary A.R.A.W. Focus:

Resilience

Developing the mental and emotional strength to absorb pressure, embrace resistance, and stay focused on your purpose.

Agility

Building the capacity to adapt your plan, pivot intelligently, and make decisive adjustments without losing momentum.

► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Practice using your M.V.P. Blueprint as a real-time decision-making filter.
- » Identify and create a strategy to manage your “internal resistance” (the inner critic).
- » Learn and apply the “reframing” technique to handle external resistance.
- » “Stress-test” your 90-Day Way goals to build proactive agility.

 Video Debrief Zone

Use this space to capture key ideas and “aha” moments from Melissa’s coaching in the Lesson 4 video topics.

 Activating My M.V.P.:



 Conditioning Resilience (Internal & External):

 Conditioning Agility (The Pivot):

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 4.1

The M.V.P. Decision Filter (Scenario)

In the video, Melissa shared the story of “Anna,” who used her M.V.P. to make a strategic decision. Now it’s your turn. Read the scenario below and use your own M.V.P. Blueprint to work through it.



The Scenario

You’ve just been invited to lead a new, high-visibility task force to solve a sudden company-wide operational issue. It’s a great opportunity for exposure to senior leadership. However, accepting will require you to work late for the next month, forcing you to miss family dinners and cancel the personal development course you committed to (which aligns with one of your 90-Day Way goals).

Run it through your M.V.P. filter. Refer back to your drafted Purpose, Vision, and Mission statements.

Purpose Alignment

Does saying ‘yes’ to this task force align with your core Purpose? Why or why not?

Vision Alignment

Does this move you closer to or further away from the 5-year Vision you defined for yourself? In what way?

Mission Alignment

Does this work fit within your defined Mission? Is this the ‘how’ you want to be spending your time and energy?

Propose a “Powerful Yes” (or a Confident “No”)

Based on your analysis, how would you respond? Draft an answer that is true to your M.V.P. It could be a ‘yes, but...’, a ‘no, because...’, or a ‘not me, but...’ that delegates or proposes an alternative solution (like Anna did).

Deeper Activation

Inner Voice & Communication

How might your inner critic (from Drill 4.2) affect how you communicate your decision in this scenario? How can you use your purpose as a counter-statement?

Wellbeing & Burnout

Journal for a few minutes on this question: How does making a decision that is aligned with your M.V.P. (like the one you just drafted) actively prevent burnout, even if it's a difficult choice?

Stakeholder Impact

Who are the key stakeholders (team, Player-Coach, family) affected by your decision? How does filtering the decision through your M.V.P. help you lead them more effectively through the outcome?

 My Notes:



Boundaries aren't
walls—they're bridges
to the life you're
meant to lead.

Drill 4.2

Taming Your Inner Critic

Internal resistance is often the biggest hurdle. Giving a name to that voice of self-doubt separates it from your true, powerful self.

Name Your Inner Critic:

What do you call that nagging voice of fear or doubt? (e.g., “The Perfectionist,” “The Cautious Committee,” “The Worrier”).

 My Inner Critic’s Name: _____

What does it usually say? (e.g., “You’re not ready for this.” “What if you fail?” “Don’t rock the boat.”)

Arm Yourself with a Counter-Statement: Write a powerful, purpose-driven statement you can use to respond to your inner critic when it appears. This should be rooted in your M.V.P.



Example

If the critic says “You’re not experienced enough,” your counter-statement could be, “My mission is to build innovative solutions, and that requires taking on new challenges. I am ready to learn.”)



My Counter-Statement:



Drill 4.3

The Reframe
(Practice)

External resistance is an opportunity. Practice the mental shift from “obstacle” to “opportunity” with the reframing technique.

Identify a recent moment of external resistance you faced. (e.g., A colleague was skeptical of your idea, you were told ‘no’ on a budget request, a project timeline was suddenly changed).

The Resistance I Faced: _____

What was your initial, instinctive reaction or thought? (“This will never work.” “They don’t support me.” “This is a disaster.”)

Now, reframe it. How could this “obstacle” actually be an “opportunity”?



Example

“My colleague’s skepticism is an opportunity to pressure-test my idea and make my business case even stronger” or “This ‘no’ on the budget is an opportunity to find a more creative, low-cost solution that could be even more impressive.”)



My Reframe:

Drill 4.4

Stress-Testing Your
90-Day Way Goals

Proactive agility is built by anticipating challenges. Look at the goals you set in your 90-Day Way Scorecard.

Select one important goal from your 90-Day Way plan.



The Goal: _____



My Notes:

Now, ask these three “stress-test” questions:

- 1

Where is this plan most likely to break? What is the single weakest link?
- 2

What is the biggest assumption I am making for this goal to succeed? (e.g., “I’m assuming I’ll have 5 hours a week,” or “I’m assuming stakeholder X will be supportive.”)
- 3

If that assumption proves false, what is my pivot plan? (What is Plan B?)

The Final Rep: Align Your Pivot Plan

An Athleader doesn't just create a Plan B in isolation; they align it with key partners. Sharing your pivot plan isn't just about informing others; it's about gaining valuable perspective and strengthening your strategy before you need it.

Your Task:

Schedule a brief conversation with your Player-Coach or a trusted peer. In that conversation:

- ▶ Share the goal you've stress-tested.
- ▶ Explain the potential point of failure you identified.
- ▶ Present your proposed pivot plan.
- ▶ Ask for their feedback: *"What am I missing? How could this pivot plan be even stronger?"*

Locker Room Reflection

After completing the drills for this lesson, what is the biggest shift in your mindset regarding how you will approach challenges and execute your plans moving forward?

 My notes



Lesson 4

Conditioning Pulse

Reflect on your experiences
this past week.

1

When faced with an unexpected obstacle this week, my first instinct was to reframe it as an opportunity.



Strongly Agree



Agree



Neutral



Disagree



Strongly Disagree

2

I feel confident in my ability to pivot from my plan without losing sight of my main goal.



Strongly Agree



Agree



Neutral



Disagree



Strongly Disagree



Reflection

What is one specific action you can take next week to proactively build your agility?





Lesson 5

Lead the 90-Day Way (Sustain & Optimize)

Welcome to the lesson where all your foundational work—your M.V.P. Blueprint, your A.R.A.W. awareness—gets translated into a powerful, executable plan. This is where strategy meets the pavement. You have the ‘why’ and the ‘where’; the 90-Day Way is the ‘how.’

The drills in this lesson are the most practical yet. They are designed to move you from reflection to structured action, giving you the clarity and momentum needed to make significant progress in a single “season.”



“What separates the 8% who succeed? It’s not just about setting goals. It’s about having a system to achieve them consistently.”



Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 5

As you build your plan, we want you to amplify its impact by considering your key relationships. Ask yourself throughout this lesson:

Who will benefit if I achieve this goal?

Who might need to be brought along with me on this journey?

► Primary A.R.A.W. Focus:

Alignment

Ensuring your goals and actions are in perfect harmony with your M.V.P. Blueprint.

Well-being

Building a sustainable plan includes celebration and prevents burnout by focusing on what truly matters.

► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Identify the essential prerequisites (“Elements of Success”) required to achieve your vision.
- » Conduct an honest gap analysis between your current state and your required state.
- » Transform your most critical gaps into 2-3 powerful SMART goals.
- » **Learn how to assess your goals against the A.R.A.W. pillars.**
- » Build out your first comprehensive 90-Day Way plan using the 90-Day Way Scorecard.

 Video Debrief Zone

Use this space to capture key ideas and “aha” moments from Melissa’s coaching in the Lesson 5 video topics.

 Elements of Success (My Prerequisites):

 Gap Analysis & SMART Goals:

 Building My 90-Day Action Plan:



A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 5.1

The Elements of Success (Your Prerequisite Check)

Before building your plan, you need to know what success requires. Based on the career path and vision you've defined, what are the non-negotiable prerequisites required?



Instructions:
For each category below, brainstorm what is required to achieve your vision. Don't assess yourself yet; just list the requirements.

Mindset

(e.g., Confidence to lead a larger team, resilience to handle executive-level pressure...)

Motivation & Energy

(e.g., Sustainable drive for a multi-year project...)

Network

(e.g., Relationships with senior-level leaders, a strong mentor...)

Experience

(e.g., P&L management experience, leading a cross-functional team...)

Knowledge/ Skills

(e.g., Deep knowledge of market trends, advanced data analysis skills...)

Resources

*(Time, Financial, etc.)
(e.g., 10 hours per week for study, budget for a course...)*

Worksheet

Current Role & Team Alignment Review the prerequisites you listed above. How aligned are these goals with the current needs of your role and the objectives of your team? Where is there synergy? Where might there be tension?

My Notes

Drill 5.2

Gap Analysis & SMART Goal Creation

Now, assess yourself against the prerequisites you just listed. Where are you strong, and where are the most critical gaps? These gaps become your goals.



Instructions:

- 1

Review your list from Drill 5.1.
- 2

Identify the top 2-3 most critical gaps that are holding you back right now.
- 3

Transform each gap into a powerful SMART goal using the template.



My Top 3 Critical Gaps:

1.
2.
3.

Transform Gaps into SMART Goals:

Template



Within **[Time-bound]**, I will **[Specific Action]** so that I can **[Measurable Outcome]**, which is **[Relevant]** to my vision of **[Your Vision]** and is **[Attainable]** with my current resources.



Example

Gap: Lack of public speaking experience.

SMART Goal: “Within the next 90 days, I will complete a public speaking course and deliver at least two presentations to internal teams, so that I can receive measurable feedback on my performance, which is relevant to my vision of becoming a recognized thought leader and is attainable with my current professional development budget.”

 My SMART Goal #1:

 Reflection & Prioritization:

- » *Of the SMART goals you just drafted, which one, if achieved, would best equip you to lead through change? Circle it.*
- » *Considering the time and energy required, what time are you willing to commit toward this primary goal each week?*

 _____

 My SMART Goal #2:

How to Assess Your Core 4 A.R.A.W. Focus

Before you build your action plan, you need to decide which A.R.A.W. pillar each goal primarily conditions. This helps you be intentional about your growth. Use these questions to guide you:

 My SMART Goal #3:

► **Does this goal build my...**

- » **Agility?** (My ability to adapt, learn, and respond to change.)
- » **Resilience?** (My ability to manage pressure, setbacks, and my energy.)
- » **Alignment?** (My ability to connect my actions to my purpose and create clarity for others.)
- » **Well-being?** (My ability to maintain health, focus, and sustainability.)



Goals aren’t just what you aim for—they’re who you become on the way there.

Drill 5.3

Build Your 90-Day Action Plan

This is the final step: building your plan in your 90-Day Way Scorecard.



Instructions:

- 1 Open your [90-Day Way Core 4 Scorecard.docx](#) document.
- 2 Transfer your 2-3 SMART Goals into Part 3: Game Plan.
- 3 For EACH goal, complete the remaining columns by brainstorming the specific actions and details needed

Locker Room Reflection

After building your 90-Day Plan, what is the biggest feeling you have (e.g., clarity, excitement, nervousness)? What does that feeling tell you about your readiness to execute?

Action Plan Checklist (for each goal):

- ☐ **Core 4 Pillar Focus:** Using the guide above, which A.R.A.W. muscle does this goal primarily condition?
- ☐ **Daily/Weekly Actions:** (e.g., Not “network more,” but “Reach out to 2 people on LinkedIn per week.”)
- ☐ **Resources Needed:** (e.g., Time block in calendar, intro from my Player-Coach...)
- ☐ **Deadline:** The specific date this SMART goal will be achieved.
- ☐ **Accountability:** Who will you share this goal with? Name them.
- ☐ **Celebration:** How will you reward yourself for achieving this goal?



Reflect on the 90-Day Plan
you just created.

1

My 90-Day Plan feels
directly connected to my
M.V.P. Blueprint.



Strongly
Agree



Agree



Neutral



Disagree



Strongly
Disagree

2

I have a clear
understanding of how my
90-Day goals will condition
my Agility, Resilience,
Alignment, and Well-being.



Strongly
Agree



Agree



Neutral



Disagree



Strongly
Disagree



Reflection

What is the biggest feeling you have
after building your 90-Day Plan (e.g.,
clarity, excitement, nervousness)? What
does that feeling tell you?



Lesson 6

Final Whistle & Victory Lap

Congratulations, Athleader. You have completed your 10-week Championship Season. You did the work, you faced the challenges, and you have emerged stronger and more aligned. This final section of your Playbook is dedicated to two critical actions of every champion: celebrating the victory and strategically planning for the future.

Use these final drills to lock in your learnings so they become a permanent part of your leadership DNA, and to build the bridge from this season's success to the next.



**“This is not the
finish line. It’s the
beginning of a
lifestyle.”**



Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 6

► Primary A.R.A.W. Focus:

Full Integration

Synthesizing all four pillars—Agility, Resilience, Alignment, and Well-being a cohesive leadership approach.

► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Conduct a “Post-Season Review” to identify and celebrate your key breakthroughs across the A.R.A.W. framework.
- » Solidify the practice of “Continuous Conditioning” as a core leadership habit.
- » Define a clear focus for your next 90-Day Season.
- » Complete your final program assessments.



Video Debrief Zone

Use this space to capture your final insights from Melissa's coaching in the Lesson 6 video topics.



Reviewing My “Championship Season”:

A large, empty, light gray rectangular box intended for writing reflections on the 'Championship Season'.



The Power of Continuous Conditioning:

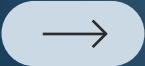
A large, empty, light gray rectangular box intended for writing reflections on 'The Power of Continuous Conditioning'.



My Leadership Legacy:

A large, empty, light gray rectangular box intended for writing reflections on 'My Leadership Legacy'.

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 6.1

Your Post-Season Review (*Celebrating Your Wins*)

Reviewing your game tape is how you encode your success. Look back over the last 10 weeks and your completed 90-Day Way Scorecard. Be specific and give yourself credit for the growth you’ve achieved.



My Biggest AGILITY Win

(Describe a specific moment you successfully pivoted, adapted to change, or made a quick, effective decision.)



My Biggest RESILIENCE Win

(Describe a moment you faced resistance or a setback and successfully reframed it or bounced back stronger.)



My Biggest ALIGNMENT Breakthrough

(Describe a key decision you made that was in perfect alignment with your M.V.P., or a conversation that created powerful clarity.)



My Biggest WELL-BEING Improvement

(Describe a new habit or boundary you implemented that had the most significant positive impact on your energy and focus.)

Drill 6.2

Your Commient to Continuous Conditioning

Athleadership is a lifestyle, not a single event.
The tools you've gained are most powerful when used consistently.

The Living M.V.P. Blueprint

Your M.V.P. is designed to evolve with you.
Schedule a “check-in” on your calendar 6 months from today to review your Purpose, Vision, and Mission statements.

Action: I will schedule a 1-hour “M.V.P. Review” on my calendar for [Date - 6 months from now].

☐ Done

The 90-Day Way Rhythm

The end of one season is the start of the next.
The 90-Day Way is a cyclical system for perpetual growth. Your final task in your 90-Day Way_ Core 4 Scorecard.docx is to complete the last section.

Action: Open your Scorecard document now and complete **Part 6: 90-Day Assessment and Reset**. This is where you will set the stage for your next season.

Locker Room Reflection: Your Championship Takeaway

Looking back on this entire 10-week M.V.P. Accelerator journey, what is the single most valuable or transformative lesson you will carry forward?

Final Steps

Your “Next Play”

You’ve done the work. Now it’s time to formalize your completion.

- 1 Finalize Your 90-Day Way Scorecard:**
Ensure you have completed Part 6 in your scorecard document. This is your handoff from this season to the next.
- 2 Complete the Post-Course Assessment:**
Your feedback is invaluable. Please use the link on the course page to complete the final assessment survey. It helps us make this experience even more powerful for the community of Athleaders who will follow you.
- 3 Share Your Accomplishments and be Recognized on the Hall of Fame:**
Reflect back to where you started. What were your initial personal and professional goals? What were your intentions? How did you grow in unexpected ways and what did you achieve? Define success on your terms and share your significant outcome.

Thank you for your commient, your courage, and your leadership. You are conditioned to win. This is just the beginning. Go forward and lead from your core. You’ve got this!

 My notes

